

And if you're thinking the average millionaire—state school or not—was an academic superstar with a perfect grade point average, let me bust that bubble for you too. Almost half of the millionaires we studied had a B average or less in school. So, if your grade reports had some Bs and Cs, don't let that fool you into thinking you aren't qualified for a \$1 million net worth. As Thomas Stanley, author of *The Millionaire Mind*, discovered through his research, "In the real world, economic productivity is not defined by GPA."^{[11](#)}

Grades only tell part of the story, though. If you look at the total picture, you'll see that millionaires are more likely to be involved in extracurricular activities in high school. Forty percent were involved in sports or cheerleading, the most common extracurricular activities. Eighteen percent were involved in student government, compared to 12% of the general population. Fifteen percent were active in the student newspaper, compared to 7% of the general population. And 17% were involved in academic teams, compared to 11% of the general population. It's clear that, even in high school, these high achievers demonstrated the drive and initiative that would ultimately lead to their financial independence.